

# Chapter 26 — Semantic Function Sorting

BBH Chapter 26 · Hiphil Strong Verbs

Classify each Hiphil verb as C (Causative), F (Factitive), D (Declarative), SA (Simple Action), or DN (Denominative). Write your answer in the Function column. Answer key is on the last page.

C = Causative (subject causes another to act/experience) | F = Factitive (subject causes object to be in a state) | D = Declarative (subject declares something as being in a state) | SA = Simple Action (Hiphil is the standard form; no common Qal) | DN = Denominative (Hiphil derived from a noun; not in BBH)

| #  | Hebrew        | Conjugation    | Ref       | Contextual Gloss                             | Function |
|----|---------------|----------------|-----------|----------------------------------------------|----------|
| 1  | וַיָּבֵא      | Wayyiqtol 3ms  | Gen 2:19  | "he brought them to the man"                 |          |
| 2  | וַתוֹצֵא      | Wayyiqtol 3fs  | Gen 1:12  | "the earth brought forth vegetation"         |          |
| 3  | וַיָּשֻׁב     | Wayyiqtol 3ms  | Gen 14:16 | "he brought back his brother Lot"            |          |
| 4  | הִשְׁקָה      | Perfect 3ms    | Gen 2:6   | "a mist watered the whole surface"           |          |
| 5  | וַיּוֹלֵד     | Wayyiqtol 3ms  | Gen 5:3   | "Adam fathered a son"                        |          |
| 6  | הַעֲלֵה       | Imperative 2ms | Gen 22:2  | "offer him as a burnt offering"              |          |
| 7  | וַתִּרְדֹּךְ  | Wayyiqtol 3fs  | Gen 24:18 | "she lowered her jar to give him a drink"    |          |
| 8  | וַיִּסֹּר     | Wayyiqtol 3ms  | Gen 30:35 | "he removed the streaked goats"              |          |
| 9  | וַיַּגֵּד     | Wayyiqtol 3ms  | Gen 9:22  | "Ham told his two brothers"                  |          |
| 10 | הִגִּיד       | Weqatal 3ms    | Gen 3:11  | "who told you that you were naked?"          |          |
| 11 | וַתִּשְׁלַךְ  | Wayyiqtol 3fs  | Gen 21:15 | "she threw the child under a bush"           |          |
| 12 | הִזְכֵּרְתָּ  | Perfect 2ms    | Gen 40:14 | "mention me to Pharaoh"                      |          |
| 13 | מֵמְזִכִּיר   | Participle ms  | Gen 41:9  | "I am bringing my faults to mind"            |          |
| 14 | הִמִּית       | Inf. Constr.   | Gen 18:25 | "far be it from you to put...to death"       |          |
| 15 | הִכּוֹת       | Inf. Constr.   | Gen 4:15  | "lest anyone who found him strike him"       |          |
| 16 | הִשְׁמַדְתִּי | Perfect 1cs    | Lev 26:30 | "I will destroy your high places"            |          |
| 17 | תִּשְׁמִידוּ  | Imperfect 2mp  | Num 33:52 | "you shall demolish their figured stones"    |          |
| 18 | וַיַּכְבֵּד   | Wayyiqtol 3ms  | Exo 8:32  | "Pharaoh hardened his heart this time also"  |          |
| 19 | וַהֲכִיב      | Inf. Absolute  | Exo 8:15  | "he made his heart stubborn" (intensified)   |          |
| 20 | וַתִּגְדֹּל   | Wayyiqtol 2ms  | Gen 19:19 | "you have shown great kindness to me"        |          |
| 21 | הִרְשִׁיעַ    | Perfect 3cp    | Deu 25:1  | "acquit the innocent and condemn the guilty" |          |
| 22 | יִרְשִׁיעַ    | Imperfect 3mp  | Exo 22:8  | "the judges shall declare him guilty"        |          |
| 23 | וַיַּעֲלֶה    | Wayyiqtol 3ms  | Gen 8:20  | "Noah offered burnt offerings on the altar"  |          |
| 24 | הִמִּית       | Inf. Constr.   | Gen 37:18 | "they conspired against him to kill him"     |          |
| 25 | מֵמְטִיר      | Participle ms  | Gen 7:4   | "I am about to send rain on the earth"       |          |
| 26 | וַיִּשָּׁכֶם  | Wayyiqtol 3ms  | Gen 22:3  | "Abraham rose early in the morning"          |          |
| 27 | הֶאֱזִינוּ    | Imperative 2mp | Deu 32:1  | "give ear, O heavens, and I will speak"      |          |

## Reflection Questions

- Items 18–19 both come from the root for "be heavy" (Exo 8). How does the Hiphil meaning connect to the Qal? Is this Factitive or Causative — and why?

2. Items 21–22 are both Declarative (not Factitive), even though עָשָׂה has a clear stative Qal. What is the difference between making someone wicked and declaring someone wicked? What makes Deu 25:1 and Exo 22:8 clearly Declarative?
3. Items 12–13 (זָכַר, "to remember") are classified as Causative. How does "mention me to Pharaoh" (Gen 40:14) fit the Causative definition? Does that reading change the translation?

## Answer Key

| #  | Hebrew        | Ref       | Fn | Explanation                                            |
|----|---------------|-----------|----|--------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | יָבֵא         | Gen 2:19  | C  | Qal = to come; Hiphil = cause to come                  |
| 2  | וַתֵּצֵא      | Gen 1:12  | C  | Qal = to go out; Hiphil = cause to come out            |
| 3  | וַיָּשָׁב     | Gen 14:16 | C  | Qal = to return; Hiphil = cause to return              |
| 4  | הִשְׁקָה      | Gen 2:6   | C  | Qal = to drink; Hiphil = cause to drink/water          |
| 5  | וַיֹּלֶד      | Gen 5:3   | C  | Qal = to give birth; Hiphil = cause to be born         |
| 6  | הֶעֱלָה       | Gen 22:2  | C  | Qal = to go up; Hiphil = cause to go up/offer          |
| 7  | וַתֵּרֶד      | Gen 24:18 | C  | Qal = to go down; Hiphil = cause to go down            |
| 8  | וַיִּסָּר     | Gen 30:35 | C  | Qal = to turn aside; Hiphil = cause to depart          |
| 9  | וַיֹּגֵד      | Gen 9:22  | SA | Rare Qal; Hiphil is operative form: to tell            |
| 10 | הִגִּיד       | Gen 3:11  | SA | Same root as #9; Hiphil = standard form                |
| 11 | וַתַּשְׁלֵךְ  | Gen 21:15 | SA | No common Qal; Hiphil = to throw/cast                  |
| 12 | הִזְכֵּרְתָּ  | Gen 40:14 | C  | Qal = to remember; Hiphil = cause to remember          |
| 13 | מִזְכִּיר     | Gen 41:9  | C  | Causing something to be remembered                     |
| 14 | הָמִית        | Gen 18:25 | C  | Qal = to die; Hiphil = cause to die                    |
| 15 | הִכּוֹת       | Gen 4:15  | SA | No Qal; Hiphil = primary form: to strike               |
| 16 | הִשְׁמַדְתִּי | Lev 26:30 | SA | No Qal; Niphal = "be destroyed"                        |
| 17 | תִּשְׁמִידוּ  | Num 33:52 | SA | Same root as #16; conquest context                     |
| 18 | וַיִּכְבֵּד   | Exo 8:32  | F  | Qal = be heavy; Hiphil = make/cause heaviness          |
| 19 | וַהֲכִבֵּד    | Exo 8:15  | F  | Inf. Abs. intensifies the factitive action             |
| 20 | וַתִּגְדֹּל   | Gen 19:19 | F  | Qal = be great; Hiphil = cause greatness               |
| 21 | הִרְשִׁיעוּ   | Deu 25:1  | D  | Legal verdict; declaring — not causing — guilt         |
| 22 | וַיִּרְשִׁיעַ | Exo 22:8  | D  | Same root; judicial pronouncement                      |
| 23 | וַיַּעַל      | Gen 8:20  | C  | Qal = go up; Hiphil = cause to go up/offer             |
| 24 | הָמִית        | Gen 37:18 | C  | Same form as #14; different context                    |
| 25 | מִמָּטָר      | Gen 7:4   | DN | Noun: מָטָר (rain); Hiphil = to cause rain / send rain |
| 26 | וַיִּשְׁכַּם  | Gen 22:3  | DN | Noun: שֵׁכֶם (shoulder); to shoulder up = rise early   |
| 27 | הֶאָזְנוּ     | Deu 32:1  | DN | Noun: אָזֶן (ear); to ear = give ear / listen          |